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Reentry Resource Checklist for Case Managers

A working tool for staff supporting people coming home.

People leaving custody face a stack of urgent, interlocking tasks in a short window, and the case manager is often the one holding it together. This checklist is a practical working tool: the domains to cover, in a sensible order, so nothing critical is missed in the first weeks. Adapt it to your program and your client's specific plan.

This is a general practice aid, not legal advice, and does not replace your agency's policies or a client's supervision conditions.

Immediate (first days)

- ☐ Confirm the client's supervision reporting requirement and first check-in date (federal supervision generally requires reporting within 72 hours of release).
- ☐ Identification: driver's license or state ID, Social Security card, birth certificate.
- ☐ Housing confirmed and stable for the immediate term.
- ☐ Any critical medication and a way to refill it.
- ☐ Emergency contacts and a plan for the first hard day.

Short term (first weeks)

- ☐ Income: benefits screening, job search, workforce program referral.
- ☐ Banking: open or reopen an account.
- ☐ Health: primary care, behavioral health, and any required treatment.
- ☐ Transportation to appointments and work.
- ☐ Phone and a way to receive mail and messages.

Stabilizing (first months)

- ☐ Address collateral consequences relevant to the client's goals (licensing, housing, benefits). See the national inventory in the sources line.
- ☐ Court and supervision obligations on a tracked schedule.
- ☐ Family reunification support where appropriate.
- ☐ Education or training pathway if that is a goal.
- ☐ Legal needs: outstanding fines, record-relief eligibility, family court matters.

Client information

Client name / ID: _____

Supervision officer and contact: _____

Next required check-in: _____

Notes and referrals made

Sources and further reading: *National Inventory of Collateral Consequences of Conviction* (niccc.nationalreentryresourcecenter.org), a free database built by the American Bar Association under a U.S. Department of Justice grant.

This workbook is educational and reflects lived and professional experience. It is not legal advice and does not create an attorney-client relationship. Laws and procedures vary by jurisdiction and change over time. For advice about your situation, consult a licensed attorney in your state.

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